

OWNERSHIP

GROWTH BEGINS
WITH OWNERSHIP



STOP PLACING BLAME. START OWNING YOUR CHOICES.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Growth Begins With Ownership

← You are here

02

The Benchmark Athletes Never Set

Coming up.

03

When Ownership Gets Hard

Coming up.

04

Ownership for Parents

Coming up.

05

Ownership as a Daily Practice

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

MOST ATHLETES THINK GROWTH
HAPPENS OVER TIME. THE REALITY:
GROWTH BEGINS THE MOMENT YOU
STOP BLAMING EVERYTHING
OUTSIDE YOURSELF.

The ref made a bad call. The coach plays favorites. A teammate showed up late. All of that may be true and none of it is why you're stuck. What's keeping you stuck is how you respond to those moments.

— OWNERSHIP IS THE FIRST MOVE · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE OWNERSHIP FRAMEWORK

AN ADVANCED MINDSET BEGINS
THE MOMENT YOU STOP PLACING
BLAME AND START OWNING YOUR
CHOICES.

→ What are you choosing to focus on right now?

→ Where are you spending your time and energy?

→ Are your actions aligned with the outcomes you say you want?

— YOU CAN'T GROW IN A STORY WHERE YOU ARE THE VICTIM.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

BEGINNER VS. ADVANCED

BEGINNER MINDSET

Life is happening to me. The coach is the problem. The team is the problem. The score is wrong.

ADVANCED MINDSET

I am making choices in every moment. Some work. Some don't. I own all of them.

THE SHIFT

You don't need perfect circumstances to take ownership. You only need awareness.



OWNERSHIP IN PRACTICE

IN PRACTICE

An athlete sitting the bench blaming favoritism may not see her own coachability signals.

WATCH FOR

Patterns of external blame: the coach, the schedule, the teammates consistent externalization.

THE SHIFT

From 'why is this happening to me?' to 'what choice can I make right now?'



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

THE MOMENT YOU STOP PLACING
BLAME IS THE MOMENT GROWTH
BECOMES POSSIBLE.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE FIRST MOVE



THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, PRACTICE ONE OWNERSHIP MOVE.

✓ Identify one situation where your athlete has been placing external blame

✓ Ask: what is one choice she could own in that situation?

✓ Practice the question: 'What can I control here?'

✓ Notice does she answer the question, or redirect back to the blame?



THE BENCHMARK ATHLETES NEVER SEE

02

COACHES DON'T JUST WATCH WHAT YOU DO. THEY WATCH HOW YOU RECEIVE.

THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Growth Begins With Ownership

Complete.

02

The Benchmark Athletes Never Set

← You are here

03

When Ownership Gets Hard

Coming up.

04

Ownership for Parents

Coming up.

05

Ownership as a Daily Practice

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

ATHLETES OBSESS OVER
PERFORMANCE. COACHES ALSO
WATCH ATTITUDE, COACHABILITY,
AND HOW AN ATHLETE SHOWS UP
WHEN THE RESULT IS NOT IN THEIR
FAVOR.

The athlete who believes she deserves more playing time and the athlete who earns it are usually different athletes. The difference is not talent it is ownership of the full picture.

— COACHES WATCH MORE THAN GAMES · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE FULL PICTURE

WHAT YOU DO WHEN YOU'RE NOT
IN THE GAME MATTERS AS MUCH
AS WHAT YOU DO WHEN YOU ARE.

→ Body language on the bench: are you in it or checking out?

→ Response to feedback: defensive, silent, or engaged?

→ Practice habits: are you performing for the coach's eyes or building actual skill?

— THE BENCH IS ALSO A PERFORMANCE. OWN EVERY MOMENT OF IT.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

WHAT COACHES ACTUALLY SEE

THE STARE

When a coach gives feedback and gets a blank expression or silence that registers as uncoachable.



THE DISTRACTED ATHLETE

Asking 'what's the next drill' mid-rep. Checking reps when the coach's back is turned.

THE INVISIBLE SIGNAL

Every small choice in practice sends a data point to the coach. Most athletes don't know this.

OWNING PRACTICE

IN PRACTICE

The athlete who cheats her reps when no one is watching is practicing dishonesty, not volleyball.

WATCH FOR

Whether your athlete shows the same energy in the third game of practice as in the first.

THE SHIFT

From performing for the coach to performing for the standard she is setting for herself.



07 · REMEMBER THIS

SAVE THIS · COME BACK TO IT

YOU ARE ALWAYS BEING EVALUATED.
OWN EVERY REP AS IF IT MATTERS
BECAUSE IT DOES.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE FULL PICTURE LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, OBSERVE WHAT YOUR ATHLETE OWNS.

✓ Watch one full practice with fresh eyes notice bench behavior and rep effort

✓ Ask after: 'What do you think your coach noticed today?'

✓ Discuss one specific moment where she could have shown more ownership

✓ Set one ownership standard for the next practice together



OWNERSHIP

WHEN OWNERSHIP
GETS HARD

03

THE MOMENTS THAT FEEL MOST UNFAIR ARE THE MOST IMPORTANT ONES TO OWN.

THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Growth Begins With Ownership

Complete.

02

The Benchmark Athletes Never Set

Complete.

03

When Ownership Gets Hard

← You are here

04

Ownership for Parents

Coming up.

05

Ownership as a Daily Practice

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

THE HARDEST OWNERSHIP
MOMENTS ARE NOT THE ONES WE
SEE COMING. THEY ARE THE ONES
THAT FEEL GENUINELY UNJUST.

A bad call. A coach's favorite. A teammate who coasts. These are real. And they are also the test of whether ownership is a mindset or just a phrase.

— OWNERSHIP UNDER FIRE IS THE REAL PRACTICE · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE HARD MOMENTS

ANYONE CAN OWN THEIR CHOICES
WHEN THINGS GO WELL. THE
REAL PRACTICE IS WHEN THE
SITUATION FEELS UNFAIR.

- Acknowledge what's real: don't gaslight yourself or your athlete about injustice
- Separate what's true from what's useful: both can exist at the same time
- Find the one thing you can own: there is always at least one choice

— OWNING YOUR RESPONSE IN AN UNFAIR MOMENT IS NOT SURRENDER. IT IS POWER.

BOTH TRUTHS

TRUTH ONE

Sometimes circumstances really are unfair. That's a valid observation and it deserves space.

TRUTH TWO

Your response to unfair circumstances is the only thing in your control. Always.

THE PRACTICE

Hold both truths simultaneously this is emotional maturity, and it is a trainable skill.



MODELING IT

IN PRACTICE

When your athlete identifies an unfair situation, validate it and then ask: 'What can you still own here?'

WATCH FOR

Your own tendency to choose a side: either dismiss the injustice or fuel the victim story.

THE SHIFT

From 'you shouldn't feel that way' or 'that's so unfair' to 'both things can be true.'



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

IT CAN BE UNFAIR AND YOUR
RESPONSE CAN STILL BE A CHOICE.
YOU DON'T HAVE TO PICK ONE.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE BOTH-AND LAW

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, PRACTICE THE BOTH-AND CONVERSATION.

✓ Find one moment where your athlete blamed an external circumstance this week

✓ Validate it first: 'That does sound hard/unfair.'

✓ Then ask: 'What's the one thing you can still own in that situation?'

✓ Notice what she comes up with and whether she's surprised by her own answer



OWNERSHIP

OWNERSHIP FOR PARENTS



BEFORE YOU COACH YOUR ATHLETE, EXAMINE YOUR OWN OWNERSHIP.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Growth Begins With Ownership

Complete.

02

The Benchmark Athletes Never Set

Complete.

03

When Ownership Gets Hard

Complete.

04

Ownership for Parents

← You are here

05

Ownership as a Daily Practice

Coming up.

HEAR THIS ONCE

PARENTS ASK THEIR ATHLETES TO OWN THEIR CHOICES WHILE SIMULTANEOUSLY BLAMING THE COACH, THE SYSTEM, OR OTHER KIDS FOR THEIR ATHLETE'S SITUATION.

You cannot model something you don't practice. Ownership has to be visible in how you talk, react, and show up not just in what you say to your athlete.

— YOU CANNOT GIVE WHAT YOU DO NOT HAVE · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE MIRROR

YOUR ATHLETE'S RELATIONSHIP
WITH OWNERSHIP IS BEING
SHAPED BY WATCHING YOURS.

→ When the coach makes a call you disagree with what does your response look like?

→ When the team loses who or what do you blame first?

→ When your daughter is struggling are you the mirror of ownership or the reinforcement of blame?

— WHAT YOU MODEL IS LOUDER THAN WHAT YOU SAY.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE PARENT AUDIT

AFTER LOSSES

Do you drive home in silence? Analyze the coach? Review every mistake your daughter made?

AFTER WINS

Do you celebrate the team? Or focus on what still wasn't good enough?

IN GENERAL

What is the narrative you repeat most often about her volleyball experience?



THE OWNERSHIP MODEL

IN PRACTICE

Own one thing you've been externalizing: the coach's choices, her playing time, the team's record.

WATCH FOR

Moments where you hear yourself explain her situation with 'if only' or 'the problem is.'

THE SHIFT

From being her advocate against the world to being a model of how to move through it.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

BEFORE YOU TEACH OWNERSHIP, ASK
YOURSELF: DO I PRACTICE IT WHERE
SHE CAN SEE?

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE MIRROR

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, MODEL ONE ACT OF OWNERSHIP.

- ✓ Identify one thing you've been externalizing about her volleyball journey
- ✓ Own it out loud to yourself and optionally to her
- ✓ After the next match, choose one ownership statement about your own response
- ✓ Notice if the culture in your car ride home starts to shift

OWNERSHIP

OWNERSHIP AS
A DAILY PRACTICE

OS

OWNERSHIP IS NOT A MINDSET YOU ARRIVE AT. IT'S A PRACTICE YOU BUILD.



THE SERIES

FIVE LESSONS. ONE PLAYER.

01

Growth Begins With Ownership

Complete.

02

The Benchmark Athletes Never Set

Complete.

03

When Ownership Gets Hard

Complete.

04

Ownership for Parents

Complete.

05

Ownership as a Daily Practice

← You are here

HEAR THIS ONCE

ATHLETES DON'T DEVELOP
OWNERSHIP FROM ONE POWERFUL
CONVERSATION. THEY DEVELOP IT
FROM THOUSANDS OF SMALL
MOMENTS WHERE THEY CHOSE IT
WHEN NO ONE WAS WATCHING.

Sustainable ownership is not dramatic. It's quiet. It's choosing alignment with your goals when the pull to complain or blame is strong. And it compounds over a season, over a career.

— OWNERSHIP COMPOUNDS OVER TIME · MAZEPERFORMANCE

THE DAILY PRACTICE

OWNERSHIP ISN'T A DECISION
YOU MAKE ONCE. IT'S A
DISCIPLINE YOU BUILD THROUGH
REPETITION.

→ Daily question: where did I place blame today that I could have owned?

→ Weekly audit: are my actions aligned with what I say I want?

→ Season review: what patterns of ownership or blame am I building?

— SMALL OWNERSHIP MOMENTS COMPOUND INTO A DIFFERENT ATHLETE.

05 · THE BREAKDOWN

THE LONG GAME

THE COMPOUND EFFECT

Every ownership moment adds to the next. Every blame moment does too. The season-long trend is built daily.



THE INVISIBLE WORK

Ownership that no one sees reps cheated or not cheated, attitude adjusted or not defines the outcome.

THE BENCHMARK

At the end of the season: is she more aligned with her goals than she was at the start?



BUILDING THE HABIT

IN PRACTICE

End each week with one question: 'Where did I own something hard this week?'

WATCH FOR

Whether your athlete's self-awareness is growing or whether the same blame patterns repeat.

THE SHIFT

From hoping ownership will happen to building conditions where it is practiced every day.



SAVE THIS COME BACK TO IT

OWNERSHIP PRACTICED DAILY
CHANGES THE ATHLETE. OWNERSHIP
SPOKEN ABOUT BUT NOT PRACTICED
CHANGES NOTHING.

SAVE THIS. COME BACK TO IT.

— THE COMPOUND

THIS WEEK

THIS WEEK, BUILD A WEEKLY OWNERSHIP CHECK-IN.

✓ Create one weekly question: 'Where did I own something this week?'

✓ Ask it to yourself before you ask it to your athlete

✓ Track the answers over the next four weeks look for patterns

✓ Celebrate ownership moments as wins, even small ones

